
Day 1: General Overview

Introductions

Let's get to know each other better!

Looking Forward

- Online Team Registration Due: 9/25 @ 5 PM
- Judge Training Clinic: TBD
- Debate Team Dues : 9/25 (SchoolCashOnline)
- Field Trip Form Due: 9/25 (TO MS. SRINIVASAN)
- WACFL 1: 10/18 @ Dominion High School



QR Code to RRHS Debate Team Page

Looking Forward Pt. 2 (*Novice Schedule*)

September:

Lecture 1 (Tuesday, Sept. 16) – General Overview: Team Introductions, Important Dates, Expectations & Policies

Lecture 2 (Thursday, Sept. 18) – Legislation Writing

Lecture 3 (Tuesday, Sept. 23) – Argument Construction

Lecture 4 (9/25) – Presentation & Delivery + Intros & Rhetoric

October:

No meeting (10/2)!

No meeting (10/7)!

Lecture 5 (Thursday, Oct. 9) – Topic Analysis

Lecture 6 (Tuesday, Oct. 14) – Flowing, Cross Examination, & Parliamentary Procedure

Lecture 7 (Thursday, Oct. 16) – Mock Debate + Docket Review & Last-Minute Questions

WACFL 1 @ Dominion High School (10/21)

Looking Forward Pt. 3 (*Varsity Schedule*)

September:

Lecture 1 (9/16) – Welcome Back! – Important Dates, Expectations, Conduct

Lecture 2 (9/18) – *Argumentation*

(Review Argumentation Slides Before Meeting 9/18)

Lecture 3 (9/23) – Delivery Drills

(Discuss w/ Pasarti, Oodie, & Team)

Lecture 4 (9/25) – Topic Analysis Workday

(Decide on structure & format of TA document)

October:

No meeting Thursday 10/2 – Holiday

No meeting Tuesday 10/7 – Faculty Meeting

Lecture 5 (10/9) – Legislation Workday

Lecture 6 (10/14) – How to Preside + Flowing

Lecture 7 (10/16) – Refutation & Weighing

Lecture 8 (10/17) – Mock Debate

(Decide on legislation + logistics)

Lecture 9 (10/16) – Docket Analysis + Last Minute Questions

WACFL 1 @ Dominion High School (10/18)

Expectations, Policies & Conduct Pt. 1

- Most of your **research** should be done outside of our practices! Practice is designed to work on debate skills (speaking, argument construction) and help brainstorm ideas for speeches.
- **Meetings** will begin promptly at 4:30 PM and will end no later than 5:35 PM.
- It is expected that each student's parent/guardian or an older sibling over 18 judge **at least one tournament** per year.
- **Attendance** is mandatory! Only three absences per quarter (exception made for athletes). Attendance is taken.
 - ◆ If you have to miss practice due to a specific conflict, you must let the officers or sponsors know.
- **Legislation** **MUST** be turned in on time.
 - ◆ Will always be due two Saturdays prior the tournament.

Structure, Organization, & Processes Pt. 1

What is Congress?

- Students role play as Congresspeople and draft legislation, which they and their peers later debate and vote to pass into law.
 - Legislation is the proposed course of action(s) that Congress should take to address the issue. *Think Medicare & Obamacare!*
- Combination of both speech and debate:
 - You will need to develop **good speech skills** since you're supposed to present yourself as a Congress person
 - You will need to develop **good debate skills** since it is Congressional "Debate" and you need to make arguments and address your peers in round.

Structure, Organization, & Processes Pt. 2

Pre-tournament:

- In advance of the tournament, a list of 9 topics – with 3 topics per committee – Foreign, Domestic, Economic is released. Students draft legislation addressing the topics. A docket of all submitted legislation is distributed to participating schools in advance of the tournament so students can look at the different legislations and prepare themselves.

Tournament Set-Up:

- Debaters will look through the docket of legislations and decide which legislation to use for each topic.
- They will then chat amongst themselves (16 – 20 students per chamber) to see who has speeches on what topics, and then collectively decide on an agenda (order of topics debated) to prioritize topics that will involve the heaviest amounts of debate.

The Debate

- **Chambers** - Upon arriving, participants will be split into different rooms, or chambers.
- **Committees** - Within that chamber, participants will be split into three committees - domestic, international, & economic. You can choose your committee. During committee time, you discuss which legislation to debate and in which order to debate.
 - **Electing the Presiding Officer** - The Presiding Officer (P.O) is elected from within the chamber and is responsible for handling motions, recognizing speakers, and maintaining decorum in the chamber. There is a new Presiding Officer every session of the debate.
 - **Setting the Agenda** - Based on the discussions during committee time, individuals will suggest an agenda. Topics are discussed in the order of Domestic, Economic, and International. Participants vote on this agenda and amend it if it does not get a majority vote. Keep in mind that not every piece of legislation will be debated so keep your speeches flexible.

The Debate

During the Debate:

- Student who wrote the legislation (or sponsoring it) will deliver the initial 3-minute speech advocating for the legislation followed by Q&A.
- An opposing speaker rises and gives a 3-minute speech of why the legislation should **not** get passed
- The Presiding Officer continues to call on speakers until debate on a topic is exhausted.
- Depending on when you speak, you will be subjected to either 2-minutes or 1-minute of cross examination
 - Try to find faults in the speaker's contentions to later use to your advantage in your speech
 - Clarify any ambiguous or confusing statements made by the speaker

Congress Terminology

- **Legislation** – Specific, written proposal to become a law that will be debated
 - **Bill** – Describes how a policy would be enacted, if voted into law.
 - **Resolution** – Expression of conviction, value/belief of Congress, which may urge, or request further action
- **Docket** – A document full of all the legislation there is – typically sent out a week prior to tournament
- **Presiding Officer** – Also called the chair. The debate “moderator”
 - Always a student debater, and is collectively chosen by the committee who runs the chamber recognizing members to speak
- **Parliamentarian** – An adult who oversees the general debate
- **Motion** – A proposal by a debater for the chamber to take a certain action
 - Additional questioning period, voting, etc.
- **Sessions** – Section of debate – usually 3 sessions in a tournament

Parliamentarian & Judges

Judge - Each chamber has two adult judges who score your speech. Each judge scores your speech out of 6 points. Further, each judge ranks competitors each session 1 through 8. If you do not make it to the judge's top 8, you will be automatically assigned a rank of 9. The more speeches you give, the more active you are, the higher your chance is to qualify. Judges will rotate out every session of debate.

Judges evaluate debaters on their originality of thought, organization, evidence, delivery, & poise.

Your goal is to accumulate the least number of points possible. For instance, a debater who receives a rank of 1 from both judges in each session will have a total score of 6, while a debater who consistently receives a rank of 9 in every session will have a cumulative score of 54.

Place	Entry	State	S1 J1	S1 J2	S2 J1	S2 J2	S3 J1	S3 J2	PARL	Rk	Rcp	PRk
1	Woodgrove Lily McBride	VA	4	2	3	4	2	2	2	19.00	2.83	2.00
2	Potomac Avi Agarwal	VA	1	6	2	1	4	5	1	20.00	4.12	1.00
3	Broad Run Aaryan Kanhere	VA	2	5	6	2	7	3	4	29.00	2.09	4.00
4	Potomac Alexander Bauer	VA	8	9	5	3	1	1	3	30.00	3.10	3.00
5	Lake Braddock Secondary Aidan Chomicki	VA	5	1	1	9	3	8	5	32.00	2.97	5.00
6	Broad Run Maryam Imran	VA	6	4	4	6	9	9	9	47.00	1.17	9.00
7	George C Marshall Ryan Hassan	VA	3	7	9	9	8	7	6	49.00	1.13	6.00
8	Lightridge Sydney Tate	VA	7	3	8	7	9	6	9	49.00	1.13	9.00
9	Rock Ridge Advait Bhamidipati	VA	9	9	9	9	5	4	9	54.00	1.00	9.00
10	Jackson-Reed Malcolm Hornsby	DC	9	8	9	5	9	9	7	56.00	0.91	7.00
11	Dominion Ayana Chowdhury	VA	9	9	7	9	6	9	8	57.00	0.88	8.00
12	James Madison Tatiana Francois	VA	9	9	9	8	9	9	9	62.00	0.79	9.00
13-T	Rock Ridge Aarush Seelam	VA	9	9	9	9	9	9	9	63.00	0.77	9.00
13-T	Rock Ridge Saaketh Vemareddy	VA	9	9	9	9	9	9	9	63.00	0.77	9.00
13-T	Chantilly Isabelle Fernandez	VA	9	9	9	9	9	9	9	63.00	0.77	9.00

Parliamentarian & Judges

Parliamentarian – While the session is run by the Presiding Officer, each chamber has a Parliamentarian who oversees the PO and ensures that all rules are being followed. He or she can also act as a judge in case of a conflict of interest. Unlike judges, the parliamentarian does not rotate out after each session.

Similar to judges, the parli ranks competitors 1 through 8. If you do not make it to the parli's top 8, you will be automatically assigned a rank of 9.

Parliamentarians evaluate debaters based on their activity in the chamber, both number and quality of questions, courtesy, correct use of procedure, and overall impression.

Speaking, Precedence & Recency

Precedence –

- Representatives who have spoken the least number of times have precedence
- Ex. Bob has spoken twice and Allison has spoken once and both of them raise their placard to be recognized, Allison will be called on because she has **precedence**.

Recency–

- Representatives who have spoken the least recently, have recency.
- Ex. Both Bob and Allison have spoken twice and both of them raise their placard to be recognized, Bob will be recognized because he spoke less recently, or earlier, than Allison.

The only time Precedence & Recency is not taken into account is the authorship speech. If a Representative who wrote the bill or resolution is present in the chamber, he or she gets to speak regardless of Precedence & Recency.

The number of questions you ask has no effect on the precedence/recency of your speeches.

If you have
questions, contact

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